Gamification and student motivation

Field: Education | Years: 2021-2026 | 4 papers

#	Title	Author(s) & Year	Quartile	Method	Access	Introduction	Methodology	Results	Discussion	Theoretical Framework
1	Gamified quizzes and intrinsic motivation among Malaysian undergraduates doi:10.1/a	Tan & Rahman (2023)	Unranked/ Unavailable	Quantitative	Unclear	Asks whether gamified quizzes raise undergraduates' intrinsic motivation.	Cross-sectional survey of 320 undergraduates at two public universities; PLS-SEM.	Gamified quiz use predicted intrinsic motivation (beta = 0.38, p < .001).	Read as support for SDT; authors urge autonomy-supportive quiz design.	Self-Determination Theory
2	Leaderboards in secondary science classrooms doi:10.1/b	Lee (2022)	Unranked/ Unavailable	Quantitative	Unclear	Tests how leaderboards affect engagement in secondary science lessons.	Quasi-experiment with 140 pupils in Penang over 8 weeks.	Not retrieved (results section missing from the available copy).	Warns that leaderboards may demotivate low-performing pupils.	Not explicitly stated
3	Students' lived experience of gamified learning	Ali & Wong (2024)	N/A (thesis/ preprint/ conference)	Qualitative	Unclear	Explores how students experience gamified courses (PhD thesis, Universiti Example).	Interviews with 18 students; thematic analysis.	Three themes emerged: competition, autonomy and fatigue.	Gamification fatigue appears after about week 6 of a course.	Flow theory
4	Badges and engagement in MOOCs: a review doi:10.1/d	Ali (2021)	Unranked/ Unavailable	Theoretical/ Review	Unclear	Reviews the evidence on digital badges in MOOCs.	Narrative review of 40 studies.	24 of 40 studies linked badges to short-term gains in completion.	Long-term effects of badges remain unclear.	Goal-setting theory

Synthesis

Motivation theories anchor three of the four papers, each a different one: Self-Determination Theory (Tan & Rahman, 2023), Flow theory (Ali & Wong, 2024) and Goal-setting theory (Ali, 2021); Lee (2022) states no framework. Methods are mixed: two quantitative studies (a survey with PLS-SEM and a quasi-experiment), one qualitative thesis and one narrative review, with no mixed-methods or longitudinal design. Quartile balance could not be judged: none of the three journals was found in Scimago, so all are Unranked/Unavailable, and the fourth item is a thesis; check the journal names against Scopus before relying on these sources. Recurring tension: game elements show short-term motivational gains (beta = 0.38 for quizzes; completion gains in 24 of 40 badge studies) while two papers flag downsides (leaderboards demotivating low performers; fatigue after about week 6). Gaps your study could fill: effects beyond a single semester, which element (quizzes, leaderboards, badges) drives motivation, how prior achievement moderates leaderboard effects, and a mixed-methods design linking survey effects to student experience. The Lee (2022) results must be retrieved before its effect can be compared.